Russell Dudek

Interview Thesis Brief

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https://russelldudek.github.io/PNC/

PNC Enterprise Engineer Sr - AI | Requisition 71280

Core thesis: Scale the work. Not just the prompt.

The actual work

Turn process-heavy internal work into secure, governed, reusable AI-assisted workflows that improve productivity while preserving the right human decisions and creating evidence for engineering, risk, and continuous improvement.

Why now

- PNC has publicly described an enhanced Enterprise AI Strategy and deployment of generative AI platforms including Microsoft Copilot.
- The next constraint is not model access. It is repeatable workflow engineering, adoption, controls, and measurable operating value.
- Amy Crisanti appears to bring long software-engineering and institutional experience; expect scrutiny on solution structure, testing, maintainability, and truthfulness.

Operating tensions

- Speed versus bank-grade controls
- Prompt experimentation versus engineering discipline
- Enterprise reuse versus process specificity
- Automation versus retained human authority
- Technical capability versus adoption and value

AI Work Control Envelope

Business intent

The task, decision, user, outcome, and exception burden are explicit.

Approved context

Sources, freshness, data classification, and retrieval boundaries are known.

Tool authority

Allowed actions, permissions, identity, and transaction boundaries are constrained.

Evaluation evidence

Representative, edge, adversarial, safety, and regression cases are passed.

Human decision

Approval, override, escalation, and accountable owner are named.

Operating record

Prompts, versions, inputs, tool calls, outputs, overrides, and outcome telemetry are traceable.

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Evidence map and likely questions

Proof map

Vape-Jet

Current direct execution across AI-assisted operations, support, quality, engineering issue flow, ERP, collaboration systems, and telemetry.

DudeWorth

Agentic workflow patterns, structured context, retrieval, human review, evaluation, governance, reuse, and time-to-value.

Amazon

24/7 operating mechanisms, visible work, standardization, escalation, adoption, and customer-backward discipline.

Compunetics

High-reliability engineering and manufacturing, quality systems, root cause, process controls, and technical stakeholder translation.

Strongest plausible concern

Is Russell hands-on enough for an individual-contributor engineering role, and can he translate beyond prompt craft into secure, testable, maintainable workflow systems?

Response: lead with direct workflow, prompt, retrieval, evaluation, human-review, telemetry, and operating-mechanism work. Be exact about coding depth. Do not claim deep Java or .NET engineering. Show how modular design, explicit interfaces, tests, and technical translation reduce delivery risk.

Likely questions and answer spine

Walk me through an agentic workflow.

Baseline process -> structured intake/context -> agent role -> approved tools -> human checkpoint -> evaluation -> operating measures -> learning loop.

How do you evaluate prompts?

Version control, representative set, expected outputs, groundedness, completeness, consistency, refusal behavior, edge cases, adversarial cases, and regression.

How do you secure agents?

Data classification, least privilege, identity, allowlisted tools, prompt-injection defenses, output validation, logging, and human approval for consequential actions.

How do SOLID principles apply?

One bounded responsibility; small interfaces; replaceable providers; business logic independent from one model; orchestration, retrieval, tools, and evaluation separated.

Why an IC role after director titles?

The role matches how I work best: directly inside the process and mechanism, translating between operating reality and technical implementation.

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30-minute plan, questions, and closing

30-minute conversation plan

- 0-4 minutes: establish motivation and clarify the role objective.
- 4-15 minutes: give one detailed workflow example with retained human authority and measures.
- 15-24 minutes: technical discussion on evaluation, security, modularity, and stakeholder translation.
- 24-29 minutes: ask high-value discovery questions.
- 29-30 minutes: close with the thesis and immediate contribution.

Questions for Amy

- When you say 'scale prompts,' what is the primary unit of scale: more users, more processes, reusable engineering patterns, or an internal platform capability?
- How does work move today from a process owner's idea through engineering, quality, security, and approval into a production workflow?
- What would make you say after 90 days that this person is materially changing how the organization uses AI?
- What does five-day onsite collaboration enable for this team that would be difficult to accomplish remotely?

Closing statement

I enter messy, process-intensive environments, make the work and decision boundaries visible, build bounded AI assistance with technical teams, test it like a real system, and instrument whether it improved the operation. That is how I would help PNC scale useful AI without scaling ambiguity or unmanaged risk.

Interview integrity

Use this brief before the call. During the live interview, no AI assistant, teleprompter, or outside support. Camera on, direct answers, and precise evidence.